

# Cameron Pattison

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## AREAS

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**Areas of Specialization:** Philosophy of Computing, Applied Ethics, Formal Epistemology, Political Philosophy

**Areas of Competence:** Epistemology, Ethics, Ancient Philosophy, Islamic Philosophy

## EDUCATION

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| <b>Ph.D. Philosophy</b> , Vanderbilt University                                | 2023–2029 (expected) |
| <i>Dissertation: A General Ethics of Speaking for Others</i>                   |                      |
| Advisors: Rob Talisse and David Thorstad                                       |                      |
| Teaching Certificate (Spring 2025)                                             |                      |
| AI and Data Ethics (AIDE) Fellowship, Northeastern University (Summer 2025)    |                      |
| <b>M.A. Philosophy</b> , Boston College                                        | 2021–2023            |
| <b>B.A. Philosophy, with honors</b> , Colorado College, <i>Magna Cum Laude</i> | 2014–2018            |

## PUBLICATIONS

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### *Peer-Reviewed and Edited Volumes*

- Pattison, C., Manuali, L., & Lazar, S. (forthcoming). “Blind Refusal: Unintended Consequences of LLM Safety Training.” *COLM 2026*. (Accepted July 2026.) arXiv preprint.
- Pattison, C. (2026). “Non-Ideal Foundations for Preference-Based AI Alignment.” *Philosophy & Technology*, 39(2), 97.
- Pattison, C. (2025). “Justin Humphreys: *Inventing the Imagination*” (book review). *Graduate Faculty Philosophy Journal*.
- Pattison, C. (2024). “Revelation in al-Fārābī’s Virtuous City.” In *Mind, Soul and the Cosmos in the High Middle Ages*, Springer Studies in the History of Philosophy.
- Pattison, C., Olea, C., Tucker, H., Phelan, J., Zhang, S., Lieb, M., Schmidt, D., & White, J. (2024). “EPÉE: Evaluating Personified Expert Effectiveness.” *CS & IT Conference Proceedings*.

### *Public Philosophy*

- Pattison, C., Ricks, V., & Wihbey, J. (2025). “How AI-Driven Search May Reshape Democracy, Economics, and Human Agency.” *Tech Policy Press*.

### *Working Papers*

- Pattison, C., Boulos, M., Kolt, N., Li, C., Piccardi, T., & Lazar, S. (2026). “The Agentic Web Requires New Normative Infrastructure.” arXiv:2606.10711.

Zainaldin, J. L., Pattison, C., Marai, M., Wu, J., & Schiefsky, M. J. (2026). “Evaluating LLM-Based Translation of a Low-Resource Technical Language: The Medical and Philosophical Greek of Galen.” arXiv:2602.24119.

## RESEARCH

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- Researcher**, ANU MINT Lab — *Evading Unjust Policy* 2025–present  
Investigating compliance overspill in LLM safety systems — cases where AI refusals block ethically and legally permissible actions. Designed evaluation dataset, LLM-as-judge pipeline, and operational validity gates. Paper (“Blind Refusal”) accepted at COLM 2026.
- Principal Investigator**, Lacy-Fischer Interdisciplinary Research Grant 2025–present  
Computational text analysis and topic modeling examining ideological differences in AI research across institutional contexts (with Sociology Department).
- Researcher**, Vanderbilt University, Levin Lab 2025–present  
Experimental design and philosophical framing for AI-driven chatbot interventions aimed at improving students’ moral reasoning.
- Researcher**, Vanderbilt & Harvard — The Galen Project 2024–present  
Evaluating AI translations of ancient Greek medical texts against expert human translations using automated MT metrics, expert MQM annotation, and blind preference surveys (with Classics and the Center for Hellenic Studies).
- Research Affiliate**, ANU MINT Lab 2024–present  
Editor, *Philosophy of Computing Newsletter* (weekly and monthly editions; 911 subscribers).
- Researcher**, Vanderbilt & Harvard — Source Analysis Engine Project 2024–present  
Computational approaches to classical source analysis using multi-shot API prompting and vector similarity search.
- Ethicist**, Vanderbilt University, RPW Center 2023–2024  
Ethical analysis and research design for IRB-approved study on vulnerability to AI-driven phishing attacks.

## PRESENTATIONS

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| “Computational Approaches to Philosophical Text Analysis,” Vanderbilt DSI             | Mar 2025 |
| “AI Reasoning and the Taking Condition,” Invited Talk, MINT Lab (ANU)                 | Oct 2024 |
| “Mimēsis in Early Islamic Philosophy,” Int’l Society for Neoplatonic Studies          | Jun 2024 |
| “Al-Fārābī on the Imagination,” Boston College GSA Conference                         | Mar 2024 |
| “On ‘Wanting’ in <i>Gorgias</i> 467a–468e,” Tennessee Philosophical Association       | Oct 2023 |
| “Socrates’ Critique of Interpretation in <i>Protagoras</i> 341e–348b,” Boston College | Apr 2023 |

## TEACHING

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Instructor of Record, Introduction to Philosophy (PHIL 1002W), Vanderbilt | Fall 2026 |
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| Co-Director, <i>AI and the Human</i> , Vanderbilt, RPW Humanities Center             | 2024–present |
| Co-Director, AI Alignment Workshop, Vanderbilt University                            | 2025–2026    |
| Philosophy of Mind Directed Reading, Vanderbilt University                           | 2024–2025    |
| Teaching Assistant, General Logic, Vanderbilt University                             | 2025         |
| Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Philosophy, Vanderbilt University                | 2024         |
| Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Ethics, Vanderbilt University                    | 2024         |
| English as a Foreign Language Instructor, Tayba Association for Orphans, Morocco     | 2022–2023    |
| Assistant Director, Brunswick School Vermont                                         | 2019–2021    |
| Designed and taught courses; strategic planning and administration for a new campus. |              |

## DIGITAL HUMANITIES

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| <b>Citation Map</b> — Open-source tool rendering a paper’s forward-citation network as an interactive 3D map via OpenAlex [GitHub]         | 2026 |
| <b>ArXiv Research Analysis Pipeline</b> — Automated download, topic modeling, and sentiment analysis of AI research papers [GitHub]        | 2025 |
| <b>PhilPapers AI Relevance Classifier</b> — Classification of 5,000+ entries for Philosophy of AI relevance using GPT-4o                   | 2025 |
| <b>Zotero Research Assistant</b> — Conversational AI for literature exploration with semantic search [GitHub]                              | 2025 |
| <b>Source Analysis Recommender</b> — Computational source-relationship identification across Greek and Arabic philosophical texts [GitHub] | 2025 |
| <b>Ibn Arabi Translation Project</b> — Interactive parallel text edition with AI-assisted Arabic–English translation [Web]                 | 2025 |
| <b>Classical Text Translation System</b> — Ancient text translation with BLEU and LM-based evaluation [GitHub]                             | 2024 |
| <b>Philosophy Indexer</b> — Automated conceptual index generation across philosophical corpora [GitHub]                                    | 2024 |
| <b>Kantian Ethical Analysis Tool</b> — Interactive universalizability testing and categorical imperative analysis [Web]                    | 2024 |

## EDITORIAL WORK

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Communications and Resource Management, MINT Lab (ANU)                         | 2024      |
| Indexing, Stanford University Press — <i>Maimonides Guide of the Perplexed</i> | 2023      |
| Editor and Communications Director, Harvard Ibn Arabi Seminar                  | 2021–2023 |
| Editor in Chief, <i>Anamnesis Philosophy Journal</i> , Colorado College        | 2017–2018 |

## SERVICE

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|                                                                    |              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Active Member, Minorities and Philosophy (MAP) Chapter, Vanderbilt | 2025–present |
| Undergraduate Mentor, Undergraduate Mentoring Program, Vanderbilt  | 2025–present |

## FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

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|                                                                                                |        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Harold Stirling Vanderbilt Award (\$5,000)                                                     | 2026   |
| Anchor Award for Research, Vanderbilt Graduate Student Council                                 | 2026   |
| Berry Publication Prize                                                                        | 2026   |
| Liverpool-Vanderbilt Joint Research Seed Grant (\$15,113) (w/David Thorstad and Robin McKenna) | 2025–6 |
| Lacy-Fischer Interdisciplinary Research Grant, PI (\$6,700)                                    | 2025   |
| AIDE Fellowship, Northeastern University                                                       | 2025   |
| Berry Publication Prize                                                                        | 2025   |
| Vanderbilt Award for Doctoral Discovery (VADD) (\$5,000)                                       | 2024   |
| Vanderbilt University Graduate School Travel Grant                                             | 2024   |
| Berry Publication Prize                                                                        | 2024   |
| Berry First-Year Teaching Award                                                                | 2024   |
| Vanderbilt Philosophy Department Travel Grant                                                  | 2024   |
| Russell G. Hamilton Scholar                                                                    | 2023   |
| Ernest Fortin Memorial Foundation Summer Grant                                                 | 2022   |
| J. Glen Gray Award, Colorado College                                                           | 2018   |
| Distinction in Philosophy, <i>Magna Cum Laude</i> , Colorado College                           | 2018   |
| Phi Beta Kappa                                                                                 | 2018   |

## AFFILIATIONS

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|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Vanderbilt Lab for Immersive AI Translation (VALIANT)     | 2024–present |
| Machine Intelligence and Normative Theory (MINT) Lab, ANU | 2024–present |
| American Philosophical Association, Central Division      | 2023–present |
| Tennessee Philosophical Association                       | 2023–present |

## LANGUAGES

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**English** — Native

**Greek** — Reading proficiency (UChicago Summer Institute, 2020; Class Abroad in Greece, 2017)

**Arabic** — Reading and speaking proficiency (Qasid Summer Program, Amman, 2024; Harvard Divinity School, 2022; AALIM Morocco, 2017)

**Spanish** — Reading and speaking proficiency

## REFERENCES

**Professor David Thorstad**  
Vanderbilt University  
Department of Philosophy  
david.thorstad@vanderbilt.edu

**Professor Jacob Barrett**  
Vanderbilt University  
Department of Philosophy  
jacob.barrett@vanderbilt.edu

**Professor Seth Lazar**  
Johns Hopkins University  
Department of Philosophy  
slazar@jhu.edu

**Professor Allison McCarthy**  
Vanderbilt University Medical Center  
Center for Biomedical Ethics and Society  
allison.mccarthy@vumc.org

**Professor Charreau Bell**  
Vanderbilt University  
Computer Science, School of Engineering  
charreau.s.bell@vanderbilt.edu

**Professor Jesse Spencer-Smith**  
Vanderbilt University  
Data Science Institute  
jesse.spencer-smith@vanderbilt.edu